JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

Category : Cyber Safety & Digital Security

Module 10 - Daily Cyber Safety

Module Overview

This handbook is the capstone of your Cyber Safety journey with JanGyan. It doesn't introduce a brand-new threat — instead, it brings together everything from the previous nine modules into one practical, repeatable rhythm of daily, weekly, monthly, and as-needed habits. Think of this as your personal cyber-hygiene routine: small, consistent actions that, together, keep you protected every single day.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to build a complete, sustainable cyber safety routine for yourself and your family.

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Understand what "cyber hygiene" means and why it must be routine, not occasional
- Apply a simple daily checklist covering the highest-impact safety habits
- Apply weekly and monthly review habits that catch problems early
- Know exactly what to do immediately if something goes wrong
- Bring your whole family into a shared, sustainable cyber safety routine
- Tie together everything learned across all nine previous JanGyan cyber safety modules

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Why This Topic Matters

The Ministry of Home Affairs has required government offices, schools, colleges, banks, and public institutions across India to observe **"Cyber Jaagrookta (Awareness) Diwas"** on the first Wednesday of every month since May 2022 — a standing reminder that cybersecurity awareness needs regular repetition, not a single lesson. CERT-In similarly observes **National Cyber Security Awareness Month every October**.

> *Reality Check: Nearly every cyberattack examined in earlier JanGyan modules — phishing, OTP fraud, fake apps, weak passwords — succeeds not because protection didn't exist, but because a simple, known habit wasn't followed in that moment.*

Knowledge that isn't practised regularly fades. This module turns nine modules of knowledge into a small number of habits you can actually sustain for life.

Introduction

Cyber hygiene is the routine, repeated practice of basic safety habits — the digital equivalent of washing your hands or locking your door. It doesn't require constant vigilance or technical expertise; it requires consistency.

This module organises everything you've learned into four simple rhythms:

- **Daily habits** — quick actions folded into everyday device use
- **Weekly habits** — short reviews that catch problems early
- **Monthly habits** — deeper check-ins on settings, permissions, and passwords
- **As-needed habits** — exactly what to do the moment something feels wrong

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Fundamental Concepts

The Cyber Hygiene Cadence Framework

Cadence	Purpose	Time Needed
Daily	Prevent the highest-frequency risks (phishing, OTP sharing, unsafe clicks)	Seconds per action
Weekly	Catch early warning signs (unusual transactions, suspicious messages)	5–10 minutes
Monthly	Refresh settings, permissions, and passwords before they become stale	20–30 minutes
As-Needed	Respond immediately and correctly to an actual incident	Varies — speed matters most

This framework mirrors how the Government of India itself treats cybersecurity awareness — not as a single campaign, but as an ongoing monthly and annual cycle (Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas monthly, National Cyber Security Awareness Month annually).

Complete Detailed Explanation

Part A — Daily Habits

- Never share an OTP, password, PIN, or CVV with anyone, under any circumstance (Modules 1, 3, 4)
- Pause before clicking any unexpected link in an email, SMS, or chat (Modules 5, 8)
- Verify the payee name before confirming any UPI payment (Module 4)
- Lock your phone/computer screen whenever you step away (Module 7)
- Avoid sensitive logins (banking, email) on public Wi-Fi (Module 8)

Part B — Weekly Habits

- Review your bank and UPI transaction history for anything unfamiliar (Module 4)
- Glance through recent social media follower/friend requests for anything suspicious (Module 6)
- Check for and install any pending software updates (Module 7)
- Review any new app installs and the permissions they requested (Modules 2, 7)

Part C — Monthly Habits

- Review privacy settings across your key social media accounts (Modules 2, 6)

- Audit app permissions on your phone and revoke anything unnecessary (Modules 2, 7)
- Review and update weak or reused passwords, starting with email (Module 3)
- Check your Aadhaar Authentication History on the UIDAI portal (Module 2)
- Remove unused apps, dormant wallet balances, and inactive accounts (Modules 2, 4, 7)

Part D — As-Needed (Emergency) Habits

- If you suspect financial fraud: call **1930** and your bank immediately — the "golden hour" matters (Module 9)
- If you receive a "digital arrest" or urgent threatening call: disconnect immediately (Modules 1, 5)
- If you're a victim of cyberbullying or harassment: preserve evidence, then report via cybercrime.gov.in, 1098, or 181 (Modules 6, 9)
- If your phone is lost or stolen: report it on Sanchar Saathi immediately (Module 9)
- If you suspect a data breach: file a complaint with the Data Protection Board of India (Modules 2, 9)

Important Terminologies

Term	Simple Meaning
Cyber Hygiene	Routine, repeated safety habits that keep devices and accounts secure
Cadence	The regular rhythm (daily/weekly/monthly) at which a habit is repeated
Golden Hour	The critical first hour after fraud, when reporting quickly matters most
Privacy Audit	A periodic review of your privacy settings and data exposure
Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas	India's monthly cybersecurity awareness observance (first Wednesday)

Step-by-Step Understanding

Setting Up a New Device Safely (First 30 Minutes)

1. Enable a strong screen lock and biometric authentication
2. Turn on automatic software updates
3. Confirm built-in protection (Google Play Protect / Microsoft Defender) is active
4. Sign in only to accounts you need, using strong, unique passphrases
5. Enable Two-Factor Authentication on your email first, then banking and social media
6. Review and limit app permissions as you install each new app

Your Weekly 10-Minute Cyber Safety Routine

1. Check bank/UPI transaction history for anything unfamiliar (2 minutes)
2. Review any pending software updates and install them (3 minutes)
3. Glance through new social media follower/connection requests (2 minutes)

4. Note any new apps installed and check their permissions (3 minutes)

Real-Life Indian Examples

(Widely reported public government initiatives, described for educational awareness.)

- **Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas:** Since May 2022, the Ministry of Home Affairs has directed government offices, PSUs, banks, schools, colleges, and Panchayati Raj Institutions across India to hold cybersecurity awareness sessions every first Wednesday of the month — treating awareness as an ongoing routine rather than a one-time event.
- **National Cyber Security Awareness Month (NCSAM):** Observed every October by CERT-In and MeitY, featuring themed campaigns, workshops, and citizen resources reinforcing safe practices annually.

Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: It's been three months since you last checked your phone's app permissions.
Make this month's review the start of a recurring monthly habit — set a calendar reminder if it helps.

Scenario 2: You notice a small, unfamiliar UPI debit from two days ago that you nearly missed.
This is exactly why a weekly transaction review matters — report it via 1930 as soon as you notice, even if a few days have passed.

Scenario 3: Your family has never discussed cyber safety together as a household.
Use this module as a starting point for a shared family routine — perhaps aligned with India's monthly Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas date.

Scenario 4: You get a threatening call claiming to be the "cyber crime cell" right after reading this handbook.
Apply what you've learned immediately: disconnect, and if needed, report it yourself via cybercrime.gov.in or 1930 — the real cyber crime cell never operates this way.

Government Rules / Guidelines

- **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA):** Mandates monthly Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas observance across government bodies, PSUs, banks, and educational institutions.
- **CERT-In / MeitY:** Observe National Cyber Security Awareness Month every October, alongside continuous advisories throughout the year.
- **I4C:** Administers the national cybercrime coordination framework referenced throughout this handbook series.

Laws & Policies

This capstone module draws on laws detailed fully in earlier modules:

Law / Provision	Covered In
IT Act, 2000 (Sections 43, 66, 66C, 66D, 66E, 67 series)	Modules 1, 2, 5, 6, 8
Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023	Module 2
RBI Authentication Mechanisms for Digital Payment Transactions Directions, 2025	Modules 3, 4
IT Rules, 2021 (as amended 2025)	Module 6
RBI Master Direction on Limited Liability, 2017	Module 9

Important Statistics

Metric	Figure
Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas observed since	May 2022, first Wednesday of every month
National Cyber Security Awareness Month	Every October (CERT-In/MeitY)
Overall reported cybercrime losses in India (2025)	Approximately ₹22,495 crore
Recommended password length (passphrase)	15+ characters
RBI 2FA mandate for digital payments — effective date	1 April 2026

(Figures are cross-referenced from earlier modules in this series and official government sources through 2025–2026.)

Best Practices

- Treat cyber safety as a routine, not a one-time setup
- Fold daily habits into actions you already do (unlocking your phone, making a payment)
- Set a recurring monthly reminder for a fuller privacy/permissions/password review
- Involve your whole family in the same routine
- Act immediately and without hesitation the moment something feels wrong

Common Mistakes

- Treating cyber safety as a "set it once and forget it" task
- Only thinking about security after something goes wrong
- Letting weekly/monthly reviews lapse for months at a time

- Assuming one family member's awareness protects the whole household
- Hesitating during an actual emergency instead of following the as-needed steps immediately

Myths vs Facts

Myth	Fact
"I set up security once, so I'm covered"	Cyber safety requires ongoing habits, not a single setup
"Reviewing settings monthly is excessive"	Regular review catches small issues before they become large losses
"Only IT-savvy people can maintain good cyber hygiene"	The habits in this module take minutes and require no technical expertise
"My family already knows enough about this"	Awareness fades without repetition — regular family check-ins help

Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Build cyber safety into a repeatable daily/weekly/monthly rhythm	Don't treat it as a one-time task
Act immediately during a suspected incident	Don't hesitate or try to handle serious fraud alone
Involve your whole family in the routine	Don't assume awareness is a purely individual responsibility
Set calendar reminders for monthly reviews	Don't let reviews lapse indefinitely

Safety Tips

For Individuals
- Attach cyber safety habits to existing daily routines for consistency
- Use a calendar reminder for your monthly review

For Families
- Discuss this checklist together and assign a "family cyber safety day"
- Make sure children and seniors both know the emergency (as-needed) steps

For Workplaces
- Align internal awareness sessions with India's monthly Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas date
- Encourage colleagues to share this routine with their own families

Practical Checklist

Daily
- [ ] Never share OTP/PIN/password/CVV with anyone
- [ ] Pause before clicking unexpected links
- [ ] Verify payee name before confirming UPI payments
- [ ] Lock device screen when stepping away
- [ ] Avoid sensitive logins on public Wi-Fi

Weekly
- [ ] Review bank/UPI transaction history
- [ ] Check for and install pending updates
- [ ] Review new social media follower/connection requests
- [ ] Check permissions on any newly installed app

Monthly
- [ ] Review privacy settings on key social accounts
- [ ] Audit and revoke unnecessary app permissions
- [ ] Update weak or reused passwords, starting with email
- [ ] Check Aadhaar Authentication History
- [ ] Remove unused apps/dormant wallets/inactive accounts

As-Needed
- [ ] Call 1930 + bank immediately for suspected financial fraud
- [ ] Disconnect immediately from any "digital arrest" or threat call
- [ ] Preserve evidence, then report harassment via cybercrime.gov.in/1098/181
- [ ] Report lost/stolen phones via Sanchar Saathi
- [ ] Report data breaches to the Data Protection Board of India

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Quick Revision Notes

- Cyber hygiene = routine, repeated safety habits, not a one-time setup
- Four cadences: Daily (seconds), Weekly (minutes), Monthly (deeper review), As-Needed (immediate response)
- India observes cybersecurity awareness monthly (Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas) and annually (NCSAM in October)
- Every habit in this checklist maps back to a concept covered in Modules 1–9
- Speed and consistency matter more than technical expertise

Key Takeaways

1. Cyber safety succeeds through small, repeated habits — not one perfect setup
2. Daily habits prevent the highest-frequency risks; monthly reviews catch what slips through
3. Involving your whole family multiplies the protection of this routine
4. Knowing your as-needed steps in advance means you won't hesitate when it matters most
5. This checklist is the practical summary of everything covered across the Cyber Safety & Digital Security category

Glossary

- **Cadence** — The regular rhythm at which a habit is repeated (daily/weekly/monthly)
- **Cyber Hygiene** — Routine, repeated safety habits protecting devices and accounts
- **Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas** — India's monthly cybersecurity awareness observance
- **Golden Hour** — The critical first hour after fraud for reporting
- **Privacy Audit** — A periodic review of privacy settings and data exposure

Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is cyber hygiene?
The routine, repeated practice of basic safety habits that keep your devices and accounts secure over time.

2. Why isn't a one-time security setup enough?
Threats, settings, and personal circumstances change — regular review catches new risks and stale settings.

3. How much time does daily cyber hygiene really take?
Just seconds per action, since these habits fold into things you already do.

4. What should I check every week?
Bank/UPI transactions, pending updates, new social media requests, and new app permissions.

5. What should I check every month?
Privacy settings, app permissions, password strength, Aadhaar authentication history, and unused accounts/apps.

6. What is Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas?
India's monthly cybersecurity awareness observance, held on the first Wednesday of every month since May 2022.

7. When is National Cyber Security Awareness Month observed?
Every October, led by CERT-In and MeitY.

8. What's the single most important daily habit?
Never sharing an OTP, password, PIN, or CVV with anyone, under any circumstance.

9. What should I do immediately if I suspect financial fraud?
Call 1930 and your bank immediately — the "golden hour" significantly improves recovery chances.

10. How can I make sure my whole family follows this routine?
Discuss the checklist together and assign shared or individual responsibilities, perhaps aligned with a monthly reminder.

11. Do I need technical expertise to follow this checklist?
No — every habit here is designed to be simple and require no specialised technical knowledge.

12. What if I've never done a monthly review before?
Start this month — a late start is still far better than none, and the habit compounds over time.

13. Should children follow the same checklist as adults?
The core daily habits apply to everyone; parents should guide children through age-appropriate versions of the rest.

14. What should I do if my phone is lost or stolen?
Report it immediately via the Sanchar Saathi portal to block/trace the device.

15. How does this module relate to the other nine JanGyan cyber safety modules?
It consolidates their key habits into one practical, repeatable routine.

16. What's the fastest way to build this habit long-term?
Attach each habit to something you already do daily/weekly/monthly, and use calendar reminders for reviews.

17. Is it too late to start if I've been careless for years?
No — starting today still meaningfully reduces your risk going forward.

18. What should I do if I receive a threatening "digital arrest" call?
Disconnect immediately — this is always a scam, regardless of how convincing it sounds.

19. How do workplaces observe cybersecurity awareness in India?
Many align internal sessions with the monthly Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas date mandated for government-linked institutions.

20. Where do I report a personal data breach?
The Data Protection Board of India, under the DPDP Act, 2023.

21. What's the best way to track my monthly review?
Set a recurring calendar reminder so the habit doesn't lapse.

22. What's the ultimate goal of this checklist?
To turn nine modules of knowledge into habits simple enough to sustain for life.

Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

(For JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)

- **"Daily / Weekly / Monthly / As-Needed" cadence wheel** → within "Fundamental Concepts"
- **One-page master checklist poster (all four cadences)** → as the centerpiece of "Practical Checklist"
- **Family cyber-safety routine planner template** → near "Safety Tips"
- **Timeline: Cyber Jaagrookta Diwas (monthly) + NCSAM (annual)** → within "Government Rules/Guidelines"

Official References

- Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) — Cyber Jaagrookta (Awareness) Diwas implementation guidelines
- Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) / MeitY — National Cyber Security Awareness Month materials
- JanGyan Modules 1–9 — Cyber Safety & Digital Security category (source material consolidated in this handbook)

Official Government Website Links

- Cyber Swachhta Kendra: **https://www.csk.gov.in**
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: **https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- CERT-In: **https://www.cert-in.org.in**

- MeitY: **https://www.meity.gov.in**
- Sanchar Saathi: **https://sancharsaathi.gov.in**

Key Helplines: Cybercrime (Financial Fraud): **1930** | CHILDLINE: **1098** | Women's Helpline: **181** | Emergency: **112**

Conclusion

Congratulations on completing the full **Cyber Safety & Digital Security** category. Across ten modules, you've learned what cyber security means, how to protect your identity and privacy, how to lock down your passwords and accounts, how to bank and pay safely, how to recognise scams and social media risks, how to secure your devices and your internet use, how to report an incident quickly, and now — how to turn all of it into a habit that actually lasts.

Cyber safety was never meant to be a one-time lesson. It's a daily practice, like this checklist itself. Keep it close, revisit it often, and remember: **small habits, repeated consistently, are what actually keep you safe.**

JanGyan — Learn Without Limits
Module 10 of the Cyber Safety & Digital Security Category